



Orthognathic Surgery (Jaw Surgery)

Purpose: Corrective jaw surgery to align the jaws and teeth, often to improve function, bite, and appearance.

First 48–72 Hours:

- Significant swelling, bruising, and mild bleeding are normal.
- Apply ice packs for 20 minutes at a time during the first 24–48 hours.
- Keep your head elevated, even while sleeping.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Take prescribed pain medications, antibiotics, and anti-inflammatory drugs as directed.
- Some numbness or tingling in the lips, cheeks, or tongue is common and may take weeks to resolve.

Oral Hygiene:

- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinses instead of brushing near the surgical area during the first week.
- After clearance from your surgeon, gently brush using a soft-bristled toothbrush.

Diet:

- Liquid or pureed diet for the first few weeks.
- Gradually transition to soft foods as directed by your surgeon.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid strenuous activities for at least 2 weeks.
- Follow any elastic band or splint instructions carefully.
- Do not smoke or consume alcohol during healing.

Follow-Up:

- Regular follow-up visits will be scheduled to monitor healing and jaw function.
- Contact your surgeon if swelling worsens after 3 days, you have persistent bleeding, fever, or difficulty breathing.